

Rod's Automation Value & ROI Field Guide

Purpose: Rod must understand and believe in what he sells because he can connect a real business problem to a useful automation, explain the financial mechanism honestly, and prove the result with the client's own numbers.

The belief standard

Belief does not come from memorizing features or repeating revenue claims. It comes from five things:

1. **Diagnose:** identify the broken or inconsistent business step.
2. **Quantify:** establish what that problem costs today using the client's numbers.
3. **Prescribe:** select the smallest automation that directly changes that step.
4. **Measure:** agree on the baseline and success metric before launch.
5. **Prove:** compare the result with the baseline and report what actually happened.

Rod should be able to say:

You told me that **[problem]** happens **[frequency]**. That causes **[lost time, lost opportunity, delay, or risk]**. The 1APP automation will **[specific process change]**. We will measure **[metric]**. Based on the numbers you provided, the potential value is **[client-approved estimate]**, but the actual result will depend on lead quality, staff response, close rate, job value, and customer behaviour.

Five approved categories of business value

Never mix these categories.

1. Money saved

Directly reduces labour, rework, software duplication, missed appointments, or administrative effort.

Basic formula:

Hours saved per month × loaded hourly cost = estimated monthly labour value

“Loaded hourly cost” means wage plus payroll burden and related employment cost. If the client does not know it, use their stated hourly cost and label the result as an estimate.

2. Capacity recovered

Returns staff or owner time for higher-value work without claiming that payroll expense disappeared.

Basic formula:

Hours returned per month × stated loaded hourly cost = estimated capacity value

Capacity value is not payroll savings unless the business actually reduces overtime, avoids a hire, or lowers paid labour cost. Report the time returned and the financial assumption separately.

3. Revenue influenced

Helps the business respond to, book, follow up with, or reactivate opportunities it already has. 1APP influences the process; it does not create certainty that a customer will buy.

Basic formula:

Additional qualified opportunities × observed close rate × average collected job value = estimated revenue influenced

Use gross profit instead of revenue when margin is known:

Estimated revenue influenced × gross margin percentage = estimated gross-profit impact

4. Cash-flow improvement

Accelerates an existing estimate, deposit, invoice, or receivable through consistent reminders and clear next steps. It changes timing and collection discipline; it does not automatically create new revenue.

Useful measures:

- Median days from invoice to payment.
- Outstanding receivables by age.
- Percentage of deposits collected before scheduling.
- Value of invoices or estimates moved to a documented decision.

Do not count faster collection as new revenue if the same payment would otherwise have been collected later.

5. Risk and visibility value

Reduces forgotten work, inconsistent follow-up, untracked leads, poor handoffs, and decisions made without data. This value may be material even when it cannot be responsibly converted into a dollar amount.

ROI rules Rod must follow

- Use the client's numbers, not invented industry averages.
- Label every projection as an estimate, scenario, or hypothesis until measured.
- Separate revenue from profit.
- Separate labour capacity recovered from payroll actually eliminated.
- Never count the same benefit twice.
- Never imply that automation fixes poor lead quality, weak pricing, bad service, or a low close rate by itself.
- Never claim a review request, dashboard, or CRM directly "makes revenue." Explain the mechanism and measure downstream results.
- Never promise a percentage improvement without verified client evidence.
- If reliable inputs are missing, say what will be measured during the trial or first 30 days.

Baseline questions before recommending an automation

Collect only what is relevant to the problem:

- How many new calls, forms, chats, bookings, or estimates arrive each week?
- How many are missed, delayed, forgotten, or never contacted again?
- What is the current response time?
- What percentage becomes a booked estimate or appointment?
- What percentage of estimates becomes a paid job?
- What is the average collected job value and, if known, gross margin?
- How many appointments are cancelled or missed?
- How many staff hours per week are spent on the manual process?
- How many unpaid invoices or unaccepted estimates are outstanding, and for how long?
- What result would make the client call the automation worthwhile?

If the client cannot answer, that is not permission to invent. The first job may be to establish a baseline.

The automation value map

1. Missed-Call Rescue

Problem it solves

- The owner or staff cannot answer while driving, working, serving a customer, or after hours.
- Callers try the next company before anyone returns the call.

What 1APP changes

- Sends an approved text promptly after an eligible missed call.
- Captures the caller's need, alerts the owner, and moves the conversation toward a callback or booking.

How it may save money

- Reduces staff time spent manually identifying and texting missed callers.
- Reduces the need for constant live phone coverage for the narrow missed-call use case.

How it may influence revenue

- Recovers conversations from leads the business already paid for or earned.
- Improves the chance of contacting the caller before a competitor does.

Value scenario

Eligible missed calls × reply rate × booking rate × close rate × average collected job value

Do not present all missed calls as lost sales. Remove spam, existing-customer calls, duplicates, and non-buyers.

Measure

- Eligible missed calls.
- Texts delivered.
- Replies.
- Qualified conversations.
- Bookings.
- Paid jobs traced to the workflow.
- Median response time.

Good fit

- Call-driven service businesses where staff regularly cannot answer.

Not enough by itself when

- The business has very low call volume, poor lead quality, no one to return calls, or no consent-compliant messaging process.

Buyer-safe explanation

This does not manufacture leads. It gives missed callers an immediate next step and gives your team another chance to win business that is already contacting you.

2. Booking, Confirmation & Reminders

Problem it solves

- Scheduling requires repeated calls or messages.

- Appointment details are inconsistent.
- Customers forget, cancel late, or do not know how to reschedule.

What 1APP changes

- Provides approved booking availability, confirmations, reminders, and rescheduling instructions.

How it may save money

- Reduces scheduling and reminder administration.
- Reduces wasted travel or calendar time from avoidable no-shows.

How it may influence revenue

- Makes it easier for ready prospects to book.
- Preserves more appointment capacity for productive work.

Value scenarios

Scheduling hours saved × hourly cost

Avoided no-shows × average contribution per attended appointment

Measure

- Booking completion rate.
- Staff scheduling hours.
- Confirmation delivery.
- Attendance, cancellation, and reschedule rates.
- No-show rate before and after.

Buyer-safe explanation

The value is not the reminder itself. The value is less back-and-forth, clearer appointments, and fewer empty calendar slots.

3. Website Form / Chat Lead Capture

Problem it solves

- Website visitors submit information but receive a slow or inconsistent response.
- Contact details, service need, source, or ownership are missing.

What 1APP changes

- Captures approved lead details, confirms receipt, routes the lead, creates the correct record, and triggers the next action.

How it may save money

- Reduces manual copying and assignment.
- Reduces duplicate entry and lead-search time.

How it may influence revenue

- Shortens response time and reduces inquiry leakage.
- Helps the team act while the prospect is still engaged.

Value scenario

Additional qualified leads contacted on time × booking rate × close rate × average collected job value

Measure

- Submissions, valid leads, source capture, response time, contact rate, bookings, qualified opportunities, and paid outcomes.

Buyer-safe explanation

A form is only useful if someone acts on it. This connects the inquiry to an immediate, visible next step.

4. CRM & Sales Pipeline

Problem it solves

- Leads live in phones, inboxes, notebooks, and staff memory.
- No one can see the owner, status, last action, or next action.

What 1APP changes

- Creates one operating record with stages, ownership, tasks, notes, and next actions.

How it may save money

- Reduces time searching for information and rebuilding context.
- Reduces duplicate or conflicting work.

How it may influence revenue

- Reduces forgotten leads and stalled opportunities.
- Gives managers visibility to coach and intervene.

Value scenario

Administrative hours saved × hourly cost

Track recovered or advanced opportunities separately; do not assign revenue to the pipeline unless a specific record shows attribution.

Measure

- Records with an owner and dated next action.
- Overdue tasks.
- Stage aging.
- Lead-to-booking and opportunity-to-win rates.

Buyer-safe explanation

The pipeline does not close deals for the team. It makes ownership and next actions visible so fewer deals disappear through inaction.

5. New-Lead Follow-Up

Problem it solves

- A lead gets one call or message and is abandoned.
- Staff follow-up depends on memory or available time.

What 1APP changes

- Runs an approved multi-step sequence across allowed channels, creates tasks, and stops on reply, booking, opt-out, disqualification, or another defined outcome.

How it may save money

- Reduces repetitive manual outreach and task creation.

How it may influence revenue

- Increases the number of valid leads that receive consistent contact attempts.
- Creates more opportunities for a conversation or booking.

Value scenario

Additional qualified responses or bookings × observed close rate × average collected job value

Measure

- Contact attempts, delivery, replies, contact rate, booking rate, opt-outs, qualified opportunities, and paid outcomes.

Buyer-safe explanation

This creates consistent attempts and stop rules. It cannot make an unqualified lead buy or replace a strong sales conversation.

6. Estimate / Quote Follow-Up

Problem it solves

- Estimates are sent, then sit without a consistent follow-up process.
- Staff cannot distinguish open, replied, accepted, declined, or paid estimates.

What 1APP changes

- Triggers approved follow-up from a reliable estimate signal, records status, creates human tasks, and stops when the customer replies or the estimate reaches a final state.

How it may save money

- Reduces manual checking and reminder administration.

How it may influence revenue

- Recovers decisions from prospects who need a reminder or question answered.
- Shortens time from estimate to decision.

Value scenario

Additional accepted estimates × average collected job value

Use a measured before/after acceptance rate only after enough comparable volume exists.

Measure

- Estimates sent, follow-up eligibility, replies, acceptances, declines, days to decision, deposits, and paid jobs.

Buyer-safe explanation

This does not pressure every customer endlessly. It creates a controlled follow-up process and stops when the customer responds or decides.

7. Review Request Automation

Problem it solves

- Happy customers are rarely asked for feedback.
- Staff forget or ask inconsistently.

What 1APP changes

- Sends an approved request after a verified completion event and tracks the request process.

How it may save money

- Reduces manual sending and list management.

How it may influence revenue

- Stronger, current social proof may improve trust and conversion over time.
- The link to revenue is indirect and must not be guaranteed.

Measure

- Eligible completed jobs, requests sent, delivery, clicks, reviews received, rating trend, and later source/conversion trends.

Buyer-safe explanation

We can make the request consistent. We cannot require a customer to leave a review or promise that reviews will produce a specific ranking or revenue result.

8. Reactivation / Nurture

Problem it solves

- Past customers and dormant leads sit unused.
- Seasonal or repeat services are not brought back to mind.

What 1APP changes

- Sends an approved, segmented campaign with consent and stop controls, then routes replies and opportunities.

How it may save money

- Reduces manual list work and one-by-one outreach.

How it may influence revenue

- Creates new conversations from an existing audience instead of relying only on new acquisition.

Value scenario

Eligible contacts × delivery rate × response rate × booking rate × close rate × average collected job value

Measure

- Eligible audience, delivery, replies, opt-outs, bookings, qualified opportunities, paid jobs, and revenue traced to the campaign.

Buyer-safe explanation

The database may contain opportunity, but the outcome depends on list quality, consent, timing, offer, and customer need.

9. Invoice / Payment Reminders

Problem it solves

- Staff manually chase overdue invoices.
- Follow-up is late, inconsistent, or not stopped after payment.

What 1APP changes

- Sends approved reminders from a reliable billing signal, records tasks, and stops after payment, dispute, reply, or escalation.

How it may save money

- Reduces accounts-receivable administration.

How it may improve cash flow

- May reduce time to payment and improve collection consistency.
- It does not guarantee collection and must respect disputes and legal/compliance rules.

Value scenarios

Collection hours saved × hourly cost

Compare average days-to-payment before and after; do not call faster cash receipt new revenue.

Measure

- Eligible invoices, reminders, replies, disputes, days-to-payment, paid invoices, and outstanding balance aging.

10. AI Voice Receptionist

Problem it solves

- Calls arrive after hours or while staff are unavailable.
- Routine questions and lead intake consume staff time.

What 1APP changes

- Answers approved call types, collects approved information, handles defined questions, routes or escalates, and may assist with booking when confirmed tools are available.

How it may save money

- Reduces staff time on repetitive calls and provides defined overflow/after-hours coverage.
- Recovered capacity is not the same as eliminating a job.

How it may influence revenue

- Captures and routes callers who might otherwise reach voicemail or abandon.

Value scenarios

Routine call minutes handled × loaded staff cost per minute

Additional qualified callers captured × booking rate × close rate × average collected job value

Measure

- Calls answered, qualified calls, transfers, bookings, escalations, containment rate, abandoned calls, errors, opt-outs, and paid outcomes.

Buyer-safe explanation

AI voice is controlled coverage for approved conversations. It should escalate uncertainty and is not a blanket replacement for staff judgment.

11. Reporting Dashboard

Problem it solves

- Owners cannot see response time, lead source, follow-up status, bookings, conversions, or workflow performance.

What 1APP changes

- Organizes agreed metrics from available connected data into a consistent operating view.

How it may save money

- Reduces manual report preparation and time spent reconciling disconnected records.

How it may protect revenue

- Helps management identify leaks, poor sources, stalled work, and workflow failures sooner.
- A dashboard informs decisions; it does not create revenue by itself.

Measure

- Data completeness, reporting time, source attribution, overdue items, response time, conversion rates, and decisions/actions produced by the report.

12. Email Marketing Starter

Problem it solves

- The business has permission-based contacts but communicates inconsistently.

What 1APP changes

- Provides an approved segment, template, campaign process, sending controls, and result tracking.

How it may save money

- Reduces repeat campaign setup and manual list work.

How it may influence revenue

- Keeps useful offers, reminders, and education in front of an existing audience.

Measure

- Deliverability, opens where reliable, clicks, replies, opt-outs, bookings, and paid outcomes attributed to the campaign.

13. Social Planner Starter

Problem it solves

- Content is created but published inconsistently across approved social channels.

What 1APP changes

- Creates a controlled scheduling and publishing process.

How it may save money

- Reduces manual posting and coordination time.

How it may influence revenue

- Supports consistent awareness and traffic. Revenue impact is indirect unless a trackable inquiry or sale is attributed.

Measure

- Posts scheduled/published, failures, engagement, tracked visits, inquiries, and attributed opportunities.

14. Landing Page / Campaign Page

Problem it solves

- Traffic reaches a generic page with an unclear offer or broken conversion path.

What 1APP changes

- Creates one focused page, call to action, lead capture path, and basic tracking for an approved campaign.

How it may influence revenue

- Improves message match and makes the desired next step clearer.

Measure

- Qualified visits, CTA engagement, valid submissions/bookings, conversion rate, source, and paid outcomes.

Buyer-safe explanation

The page can improve the conversion path. It cannot compensate for poor traffic, a weak offer, or low trust by itself.

15. Custom Automation / Integration

Problem it solves

- Staff repeatedly move data between systems, re-enter information, or manage a process that standard 1APP templates do not cover.

What 1APP changes

- Connects approved systems or builds controlled logic after technical discovery and feasibility approval.

How it may save money

- Reduces duplicate entry, reconciliation, error correction, and handoff effort.

How it may influence revenue

- May shorten operational delays or prevent leads and transactions from becoming stranded between systems.

Value scenario

Transactions per month × minutes saved per transaction ÷ 60 × hourly cost

Add an error-cost scenario only when the client can document error frequency and actual cost.

Measure

- Successful transactions, failures, processing time, manual interventions, data errors, and exception resolution.

Boundary

- Rod documents the desired workflow. Tony confirms feasibility, dependencies, scope, security, and delivery before any promise or quote.

The 14-day trial value map

Every Revenue Reactivation Sprint requires one primary success event, a baseline, a written attribution method, and a hard fee cap agreed before launch.

Eligible starter	Primary success measure	Supporting measures	Do not promise
Missed-Call Rescue	Qualified missed-call conversations recovered	Delivery, replies, bookings, response time	A fixed number of jobs or revenue
Booking reminders	Change in confirmed/attended appointments	Delivery, reschedules, no-shows, admin time	Zero no-shows
Basic form/chat follow-up	Valid leads receiving prompt response	Response time, replies, bookings	More website traffic
Review requests	Completed customers consistently asked	Delivery, clicks, reviews received	Rating, ranking, or revenue increase
Simple new-lead follow-up	Eligible leads receiving the full approved process	Contact rate, replies, bookings, opt-outs	A fixed conversion-rate lift
Basic pipeline	Open opportunities with owner and dated next action	Overdue tasks, stage completeness	Closed sales without human follow-through

Worked examples for training only

These are hypothetical examples. Rod must replace every input with the prospect's own numbers and label the result as an estimate.

Example A — Missed-call opportunity scenario

A contractor reports:

- 20 eligible missed new-lead calls per month.
- 40% of missed callers reply to a prompt text.
- 50% of replies book an estimate.
- 30% of estimates become paid jobs.
- Average collected job value is \$1,200.

Calculation:

$$20 \times 40\% \times 50\% \times 30\% \times \$1,200 = \$1,440 \text{ estimated monthly revenue influenced}$$

Correct language:

Based on your assumptions, the recoverable opportunity scenario is about \$1,440 per month. That is not a guarantee. We would track eligible missed calls, replies, bookings, and paid jobs to learn the real number.

Example B — Scheduling labour scenario

A clinic reports eight hours per week of scheduling and reminder work at an estimated loaded cost of \$28 per hour.

$$8 \times 4.33 \times \$28 = \$969.92 \text{ estimated monthly labour capacity}$$

Correct language:

The automation may return roughly 35 staff hours per month for other work. That is capacity recovered, not payroll savings unless the business actually changes staffing cost.

Example C — Estimate follow-up scenario

A contractor sends 30 comparable estimates per month, averages \$2,500 collected per won job, and has reliable data showing that three additional estimates were accepted after the new process.

$$3 \times \$2,500 = \$7,500 \text{ revenue associated with those additional accepted estimates}$$

Before claiming causation, confirm lead mix, pricing, seasonality, and sales activity did not materially change. Report the observation and attribution method, not a universal promise.

Discovery-to-recommendation script

1. **Reflect the problem:** “You said approximately [number] [events] are being missed or delayed each [period].”
2. **Confirm impact:** “What does that create—lost jobs, staff time, empty appointments, slower cash, or lack of visibility?”
3. **Confirm baseline:** “What are the current response, booking, close, no-show, or payment numbers?”
4. **Recommend one change:** “The smallest useful 1APP starting point is [automation] because it changes [specific step].”
5. **Explain the mechanism:** “When [trigger] happens, 1APP will [actions], and it will stop when [stop conditions].”
6. **Agree on measurement:** “We will track [primary metric] and [supporting metrics].”
7. **Frame value carefully:** “Using your numbers, the opportunity scenario is [math]. We will treat that as a hypothesis until the data proves it.”
8. **Confirm next step:** trial if eligible; otherwise a paid implementation quote after owner approval.

When Rod should recommend nothing

Rod should not prescribe an automation when:

- The problem is not clear or meaningful.
- The prospect cannot support the required process after a lead or alert is created.
- The requested outcome depends mainly on lead generation, pricing, service quality, or human closing rather than the proposed automation.
- The client wants guaranteed revenue, rankings, reviews, collections, or bookings.
- The required integration has not been technically confirmed.
- The projected value is smaller than the implementation burden and there is no strategic reason to proceed.

Walking away from a bad fit strengthens trust and protects 1APP delivery capacity.

Rod's product-belief certification standard

For every automation he presents, Rod must be able to answer without notes:

1. What business symptom reveals the problem?
2. What root process is broken?
3. What exactly does 1APP change?
4. How could it save time or money?
5. How could it influence revenue?
6. What variables are outside 1APP's control?
7. What baseline and outcome metrics will be measured?
8. What is a good fit, a poor fit, and a required escalation?
9. What claim is safe to make?
10. What claim is prohibited?